

The silent struggles of a daughter-in-law: A call to change

Allowing a daughter-in-law to **flourish** in her own right doesn't **diminish** the family's unity—it **strengthens** it

Living in a joint family is rarely simple, but for a daughter-in-law, it may be a **delicate** balancing act filled with judgement and criticism. In many households, the role of a daughter-in-law is **laden with** unspoken expectations, leaving little **room** for her **individuality**. It's time we **acknowledge** these silent struggles and **push for** a more **inclusive** and **empathetic** family dynamic.

A daughter-in-law often steps into a household as an outsider, expected to **adapt** seamlessly to a new way of life. From changing her surname to understanding the **intricacies** of family traditions, she **embarks on** a journey of transformation.

Yet, the term "in-law" itself can feel like a trap—a **constant** reminder of her **peripheral** status in the family. For many, this word **symbolises** the invisible cage of societal expectations and sacrifices that are **seldom reciprocated**. "It feels as though I'm constantly being watched," shares Anonymous, 37, who recently relocated to live with her in-laws following her marriage. "It can be **exhausting** to sense **scrutiny** at every corner, whether it's about your **outfit** or your manner of speaking." These tales are not one of a kind. Across the nation, **countless** women **grapple with** the challenge of fulfilling the expectations of others while **striving to** maintain their sense of self.

Some of my friends and cousins **have** admitted to bending the truth just to **carve out** a little time for themselves—a brief coffee catch-up or a quick getaway to relax with friends. Some even refer to it as a means of 'escaping' the **steadfast** pressures of family life. But why should it come to this? Why must a daughter-in-law justify her need for a **breather**? The **narrative** that has been **perpetuated** for generations—that she must be the glue holding the family together—**needs** an **overhaul**. Living in a joint family should not mean sacrificing one's freedom or sense of self. **It's high time** families rethink the dynamics and extend the same **courtesy** of individuality and space to their daughters-in-law that they offer their sons.

Empathy and equality within a household **aren't** luxuries; they are necessities for **harmony**. Allowing a daughter-in-law to flourish in her own right doesn't diminish the family's unity—it strengthens it. Moreover, it sets an example for future generations, teaching them to prioritise respect over **rigid** roles.

Transformation begins with dialogue. It is essential for families to recognise the contributions a daughter-in-law makes and to **foster** open communication regarding shared responsibilities. Partners also hold a crucial position in connecting their spouses with their families, making certain that everyone feels appreciated and heard. At its core, a family is about mutual love, respect, and support. Let's replace the **stifling** word "in-law" with something more inclusive—perhaps "in-love," symbolising acceptance and belonging. After all, isn't that what a family should truly be about? For daughters-in-

law across the world, the message is clear: You are not alone in your struggle. For families, the challenge is to listen, **adapt**, and **foster** a space where everyone, **regardless of** their title, feels at home.

It's not just about rewriting roles—it's about rewriting the **narrative** for a more **equitable** tomorrow.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

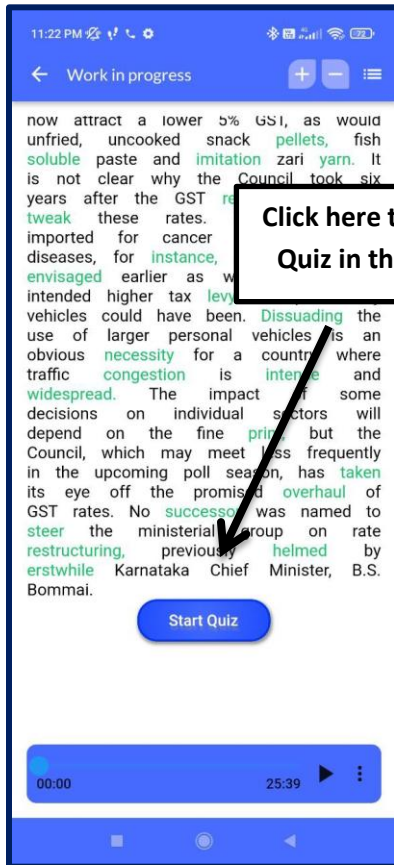
1. **Flourish** (verb) – Thrive, prosper, grow, succeed, blossom फलना-फूलना
2. **Diminish** (verb) – Reduce, decrease, lessen, curtail, weaken कम करना
3. **Strengthen** (verb) – Reinforce, fortify, bolster, enhance, solidify मजबूत करना
4. **Delicate** (adjective) – Fragile, sensitive, subtle, intricate, fine नाजुक
5. **Laden** (with) (adjective) – Burdened, weighed down, full, loaded, filled भरा हुआ
6. **Room** (noun) – Space, opportunity, scope, capacity, allowance गुंजाइश
7. **Individuality** (noun) – Uniqueness, identity, personality, distinctiveness, selfhood व्यक्तित्व
8. **Acknowledge** (verb) – Recognize, admit, accept, appreciate, concede स्वीकार करना
9. **Push for** (phrasal verb) – Advocate, demand, press for, strive for, campaign for प्रयास करना
10. **Inclusive** (adjective) – All-encompassing, comprehensive, accepting, embracing, all-embracing समावेशी
11. **Empathetic** (adjective) – Understanding, compassionate, sensitive, kind, considerate सहानुभूतिपूर्ण
12. **Adapt** (verb) – Adjust, modify, acclimate, conform, accommodate अनुकूल बनना
13. **Intricacy** (noun) – Complexity, detail, elaboration, sophistication, nuance जटिलता
14. **Embark** (on) (verb) – Begin, start, commence, initiate, set out शुरू करना
15. **Constant** (adjective) – Continual, persistent, steady, unchanging, consistent निरंतर
16. **Peripheral** (adjective) – Marginal, secondary, outer, external, unimportant कम महत्वपूर्ण
17. **Symbolise** (verb) – Represent, signify, denote, stand for, embody प्रतीक होना
18. **Seldom** (adverb) – Rarely, infrequently, occasionally, hardly, scarcely शायद ही
19. **Reciprocate** (verb) – Return, repay, exchange, respond, give back प्रत्युत्तर देना
20. **Exhaust** (verb) – Tire, deplete, drain, fatigue, wear out थका देना
21. **Scrutiny** (noun) – Examination, inspection, analysis, review, investigation जांच
22. **Outfit** (noun) – Attire, clothing, dress, ensemble, apparel परिधान

23. **Countless** (adverb) – Numerous, innumerable, many, unlimited, innumerably असंख्य
24. **Grapple with** (phrasal verb) – Struggle with, deal with, cope with, tackle, wrestle with जूझना
25. **Strive** (to) (verb) – Endeavor, attempt, try, aim, work hard प्रयास करना
26. **Carve out** (phrasal verb) – Create, establish, shape, secure, achieve निकालना/निर्माण करना
27. **Steadfast** (adverb) – Firmly, resolutely, unwaveringly, firmly established, securely दृढ़ता से
28. **Breather** (noun) – Break, rest, pause, respite, interval राहत
29. **Perpetuate** (verb) – Maintain, preserve, continue, uphold, prolong बनाए रखना
30. **Overhaul** (noun) – Renovation, revamp, reform, reorganization, improvement पुनर्निर्माण
31. **It's high time** (phrase) – Long overdue, the right moment, necessary now, critical moment अब समय आ गया है
32. **Courtesy** (noun) – Politeness, respect, kindness, consideration, civility शिष्टाचार
33. **Empathy** (noun) – Understanding, compassion, sensitivity, care, concern सहानुभूति
34. **Harmony** (noun) – Peace, unity, balance, concord, agreement सामंजस्य
35. **Rigid** (adjective) – Inflexible, strict, unyielding, firm, unbending कठोर
36. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, promote, nurture, support, cultivate बढ़ावा देना
37. **Stifling** (adjective) – Suffocating, oppressive, restraining, constricting, suppressive घुटन भरा
38. **Adapt** (verb) – Adjust, modify, alter, fit, accommodate अनुकूल बनाना
39. **Regardless of** (phrase) – Despite, irrespective of, notwithstanding, without considering, independent of के बावजूद
40. **Narrative** (noun) – Story, account, tale, description, perspective कथा/वर्णन
41. **Equitable** (adjective) – Fair, just, impartial, balanced, reasonable न्यायसंगत

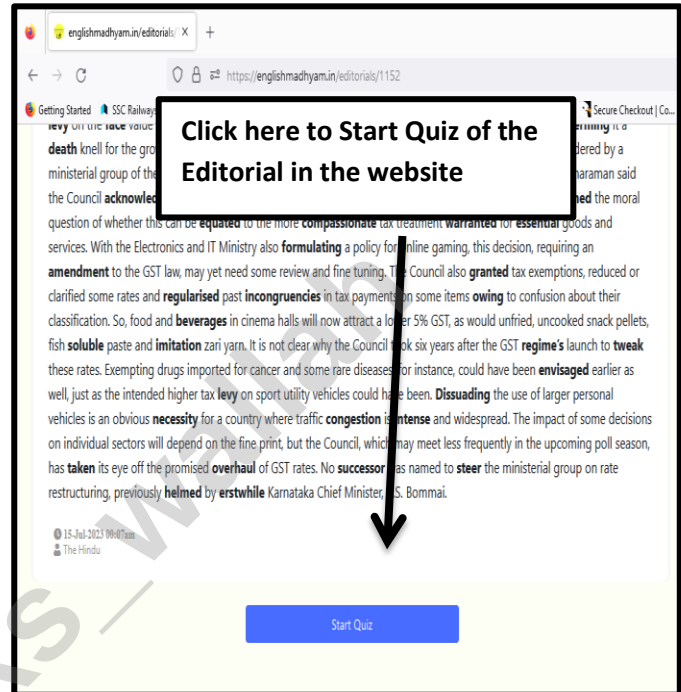
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Challenges of Joint Families:** Living in a joint family is often complex, especially for a daughter-in-law who must navigate unspoken expectations and scrutiny.
2. **Loss of Individuality:** A daughter-in-law is often expected to prioritize family expectations over her individuality, leading to silent struggles.
3. **Peripheral Status:** The term “in-law” symbolizes an outsider’s role, reinforcing the feeling of exclusion and societal pressure.
4. **Constant Scrutiny:** Many daughters-in-law feel watched and judged for their actions, outfits, and behaviors, creating mental stress.
5. **Unacknowledged Sacrifices:** The societal norm of a daughter-in-law being the family’s glue leads to unreciprocated sacrifices.
6. **Escaping Pressures:** Women sometimes resort to minor deceptions to carve out personal time, reflecting the overwhelming family pressures.
7. **Need for Change:** The narrative of a daughter-in-law as the sole unifier of the family needs a transformation to accommodate her freedom and individuality.
8. **Empathy as a Necessity:** Empathy and equality within a household are fundamental for harmony, not optional luxuries.
9. **Strength in Flourishing:** Allowing a daughter-in-law to thrive individually strengthens family bonds rather than weakening them.
10. **Role of Future Generations:** Setting an example of respect and individuality fosters better family dynamics for future generations.
11. **Open Dialogue:** Transformation begins with recognizing the contributions of a daughter-in-law and fostering open communication about shared responsibilities.
12. **Partner’s Role:** Husbands play a critical role in bridging gaps between their spouse and family, ensuring everyone feels valued.
13. **Core Family Values:** A family should embody love, respect, and mutual support, transcending rigid traditional roles.
14. **Reimagining Titles:** Replacing the term “in-law” with something more inclusive like “in-love” could symbolize acceptance and belonging.
15. **A Call for Equity:** The article emphasizes rewriting societal narratives for a more equitable future where all family members feel respected and at home.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



Click here to Start Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the Editorial in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam